

Yanqing Zhao

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No sponsorship required

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics	Expected 2026
<i>University of Illinois Chicago, Chicago, IL</i>	
M.A. Econometrics and Quantitative Economics	2021
<i>Miami University, Oxford, OH</i>	
B.A. Quantitative Economics (summa cum laude)	2019
<i>Dickinson College, Carlisle, PA</i>	
Visiting Student: Philosophy, Politics, and Economics (PPE)	2017-2018
<i>University of Oxford, Oxford, UK</i>	

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary: Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics
Secondary: Education Economics, Law and Economics, Industrial Organization

PAPERS

Working Papers

"The Price of Knowing: Pay Transparency, Labor Market Tightness, and Aggregate Wage Effects" [[Job Market Paper \(PDF\)](#)]
"The Effect of Sibling Entry Labor Market Adversities on Own Education Outcomes"

Applied Research Projects

Industrial Organization "Quantifying Market Barriers for U.S. Films in China: Release Date Allocations and Strategic Implications"
Contract Analysis "Evaluating Performance-Based Incentives: A Case Study of Newark Teachers Union Agreement, 2012-2019"

CONSULTING EXPERIENCE

Freelance Economic Impact Consultant January 2017 - August 2017

- Hired by a high-profile business and co-authored a 75-page comprehensive economic impact report that is used by the client in subsequent grant applications.
- Coordinated cross-functional operations and collaborated with 4 client departments.
- Guided survey designs and managed survey implementation (Qualtrics).
- Achieved an average response rate of 97% across market segments.

RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

Dr. So Yoon Ahn January 2023-January 2024

Department of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago

- "Marriage Migration, Value of Daughters, and Sex Selection in Vietnam"
(with So Yoon Ahn & Jaehyun Jung)

Dr. Melissa Thomasson August 2019-January 2021

Department of Economics, Miami University

Dr. Anthony Underwood & Dr. Emily Marshall June 2018-May 2019

Department of Economics, Dickinson College

- "Natural Disasters and Household Debt: Evidence from U.S. Counties"
(with Emily Marshall, Anthony Underwood, & Daniel Byun)

PRESENTATIONS

2025: UIC Economics Research Luncheon
2024: IEA Annual Meeting (Chicago, IL), UIC Economics Research Luncheon
2019: EEA Annual Conference (New York, NY)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor

University of Illinois Chicago
Public Finance (ECON 328) Fall 2024
Econometrics (ECON 300) Fall 2022, Summer 2023, Spring 2025

Teaching Assistant

University of Illinois Chicago
Econometrics (ECON 300) Summer 2022, Spring 2023, Fall 2025
Principles of Macroeconomics (ECON 121) Fall 2021, Spring 2024
Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 120) Spring 2022
Freakonomics (ECON 111) Fall 2023

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Graduate Student Seminar Co-organizer, UIC 2023-2024
Graduate Student Mentor, UIC 2022-2023
Economics Major Advisory Committee, Dickinson College 2016-2019

SKILLS

Technology Stata, R, SQL, Qualtrics, LaTeX

Causal Inference Randomized Controlled Trials (RCTs), Difference-in-differences (DiD), Regression Discontinuity (RD), Instrumental Variables (IV), Synthetic Control

Other Methods A/B Testing, Machine Learning, Time-Series Regression, Survey Research

General Applied Microeconomics, Statistical Programming, Data Visualization, Technical Communication (Oral, Written)

Certificate IRS Certified Tax Preparer (Volunteer Income Tax Assistance Program)

Language English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)

SELECTED HONORS

Winifred Geldard Award for Excellence in Ph.D. Coursework 2023
Regional Outstanding Student Award, Financial Executives International 2019
Class of 1875 Award for Best Departmental Graduate 2019
The Howard Lane Rubendall Senior Scholarship, College President's Appointee 2018
Phi Beta Kappa National Honor Society 2018

REFERENCES

Dr. Ben Ost, Associate Professor of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago
Email: bost@uic.edu | Phone: (312) 996-3913

Dr. Ben Feigenberg, Professor of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago
Email: bfeigenb@uic.edu | Phone: (312) 996-0970

Dr. Javaeria Qureshi, Associate Professor of Economics, University of Illinois Chicago
Email: javaeria@uic.edu | Phone: (312) 355-3216